

FluxReader Fixture: Conscious Overflow, Downgraded

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog on page one.

We seem to experience a rich visual world as we move through it.

Vision scientists have a special affinity for phenomenologically convincing demonstrations of visual phenomena and their limits.

When a new phenomenon works as a demo, it effectively reveals an aspect of how the mind works to anyone willing to look.

Change blindness and inattentional blindness are failures of awareness that any serious theory must accommodate in full.

In short, vision scientists take phenomenology seriously.

The key evidence for this claim is reviewed in [1]

Page two continues the argument about conscious overflow and the degree to which phenomenology outruns cognitive access. Sparse theories hold that awareness is thin; rich theories hold that experience overflows report. The debate turns on whether failures of memory or comparison can be ruled out as causes.

References

- [1] Ward, E. J. (2018). Downgraded phenomenology: how conscious overflow lost its richness. *Phil. Trans. R. Soc. B* 373: 20170355.
- [2] Block, N. (2011). Perceptual consciousness overflows cognitive access. *Trends in Cognitive Sciences* 15(12): 567-575.